posed to the state and the utility it continued to offer. The focus here is on Pakistani militant outfits. Treatment of and support for the Taliban is discussed in the following chapter. However, it is important to note that although the Musharraf regime helped to rehabilitate the Taliban, its willingness to side with the US was viewed as a betrayal of it by many of Pakistan's jihadis. Thus, the Deobandi groups, which had close ties to the Taliban, were suspect as a result of these relationships.

In addition to targeting al-Qaeda and other foreign militants aligned with it, the Musharraf regime cracked down forcefully on the sectarian Lashkar-e-Jhangvi. It had become a serious challenge to domestic order as well as an embarrassment to the state and the security services employed various measures against LeJ, including arrests, assassinations, and aggravated inter-group massacres.[1] Not surprisingly, this pressure fractured the organization. Many of its members turned against the state, strengthened their ties with al-Qaeda and became involved in many terrorist plots in Pakistan. Some outfits that had been active in Indian-administered Kashmir also came under state pressure, though not to the same degree as al-Qaeda or LeJ. Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami, which was particularly close to the Taliban regime, was put under strict surveillance and many of its cadres were detained at various times. While HuJI's Azad Kashmir chapter was allowed to remain active in Indian-administered Kashmir, its camps were raided on numerous occasions and some of its militants turned against the state.

The 'good jihadis' included Lashkar, Jaish-e-Mohammad and Harkat-ul-Mujahideen as well as other smaller Kashmir-centric groups. JeM and HuM were suspect because of their ties to the Taliban and were not allowed to be as active as they had been, but nor were they cracked down on too harshly. However, Pakistan's selectivity with regard to JeM and HuM overlooked the fact that Deobandi cadres were portable owing to their common history. While the leaders of both outfits did not break with the state, their continued relationship with a government that had betrayed the Taliban to side with the US led many members to break ranks and form their own more extreme outfits.

HuM was already weakened by the time of the 9/11 attacks, having lost much of its infrastructure and manpower to JeM. It was weakened further after 9/11 when the group lost its infrastructure in Afghanistan along with a